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Inventor(s)	Grisey; Christophe et al.

Method for managing transmissions of detection signals by a vehicle

Abstract

A method for managing transmissions, by a motor vehicle, of signals for detecting a device of a user over a wireless communication link. The method includes the steps of requesting activation, by the user of the vehicle, of a so-called “silent” mode in which the transmission of detection signals by the vehicle over the wireless communication link is suspended, it being possible for communication signals generated by a physical entity other than the vehicle to be received by the vehicle, following the activation request, detecting the device of a user outside a predetermined area around the vehicle, activating the silent mode by the vehicle when the device of a user is detected outside the predetermined area, sending to the vehicle, by the user, a signal to deactivate the silent mode from the device so as to reauthorize the transmission of detection signals by the vehicle over the wireless communication link.

Inventors:	Grisey; Christophe (Toulouse, FR), Lavin; Sébastien (Toulouse, FR)
Applicant:	Continental Automotive Technologies GmbH (Hannover, DE)
Family ID:	1000008782140
Assignee:	Continental Automotive Technologies GmbH (Hannover, DE)
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Primary Examiner: Nguyen; An T

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Buchanan Ingersoll & Rooney PC

Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) This application is the U.S. National Phase Application of PCT International Application No. PCT/EP2022/067926, filed Jun. 29, 2022, which claims priority to French Patent Application No.

2107115, filed Jun. 30, 2021, the contents of such applications being incorporated by reference herein.

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

(2) The present invention relates to the automotive field and relates more particularly to a method for managing transmissions of detection signals by a motor vehicle.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

(3) Nowadays, many motor vehicles comprise a passive access system able to unlock the opening panels of the vehicle simply by approaching said vehicle with a badge.

(4) In a known manner, the vehicle periodically transmits a detection signal which, when it is received by the badge, causes an exchange of communication signals between the badge and the vehicle in order to authenticate the badge and unlock the opening panels. The transmission of the detection signal is carried out in the low-frequency radio band (LF) in order to limit the energy required for said transmission, whereas the exchanges of communication signals between the vehicle and the badge are carried out in the radiofrequency radio band (RF) in order to authenticate said badge.

(5) However, the periodic transmission of detection signals until the vehicle user arrives leads to a large consumption of electrical energy, in particular when the vehicle is parked for a long period, for example over several days. In addition, these detection signals can be used in order to hack the vehicle in order to unlock the access points thereof.

(6) There is therefore a need for a simple and effective solution in order to at least partially overcome these disadvantages.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(7) For this purpose, the first aspect of the invention is a method for managing transmissions, by a motor vehicle, of signals for detecting a user device over a wireless communication link, said method comprising the steps of: requesting activation, by the user of the vehicle, of a so-called "silent" mode in which the transmission of detection signals by the vehicle over the wireless communication link is suspended, it being possible for communication signals generated by a physical entity other than the vehicle to be received by said vehicle, following the activation request, detecting the user device outside a predetermined area around the vehicle, activating said silent mode by the vehicle when the user device has been detected outside the predetermined area, sending to the vehicle, by the user, a signal to deactivate the silent mode from the user device so as to reauthorize the transmission of detection signals by the vehicle over the wireless communication link.

(8) The method according to an aspect of the invention makes it possible to manage the transmission of signals by the vehicle when the user is far from said vehicle, in a simple, quick and efficient manner. The method thus advantageously makes it possible to save electrical energy of the vehicle when the user is far from the vehicle, in particular when the user leaves his vehicle in a long-term parking lot.

(9) The wireless communication link is preferably of the LF type.

(10) Alternatively, the wireless communication link is of the BLE, Wi-Fi, Li-Fi, UWB or RAN type, or any other suitable type.

(11) The activation request can be produced automatically via the user device or any other suitable device, or else manually by the user.

(12) In an embodiment, the activation request is produced by the user from inside the vehicle.

(13) Advantageously, the activation request is produced by the user from inside the vehicle by pressing a button or via a touch screen.

(14) Alternatively, the activation request is produced by the user from inside the vehicle via the user device.

(15) In another embodiment, the activation request is produced by the user from outside the vehicle via the user device.

- (16) Advantageously, the activation of the silent mode by the vehicle is carried out when the user device has been detected outside the predetermined area at the end of a predetermined period.
- (17) According to one aspect of the invention, the user device is an electronic key, a badge or a smartphone.
- (18) According to another aspect of the invention, the signal for deactivating the silent mode is sent over a second wireless communication link or else is generated following the activation of a button of the vehicle.
- (19) The second wireless communication link is of the RF type. Alternatively, the wireless communication link is of the BLE, Wi-Fi, Li-Fi, UWB or RAN type, or any other suitable type.
- (20) An aspect of the invention also relates to a computer program product characterized in that it contains a set of program code instructions that, when they are executed by one or more processors, configure the one or more processors to implement a method as set out above.
- (21) An aspect of the invention also relates to an electronic control module for a motor vehicle, said electronic control module being configured for: receiving an activation request, produced by the user of the vehicle, of a so-called “silent” mode in which the transmission of detection signals by the vehicle over the wireless communication link is suspended, it being possible for communication signals generated by a physical entity other than the vehicle to be received by said vehicle, following the activation request, detecting the user device outside a predetermined area around the vehicle, activating said silent mode, by the vehicle, when the user device has been detected outside the predetermined area, receiving a signal for deactivating the silent mode, sent by the user from the user device, reauthorizing the transmission of detection signals by the vehicle over the wireless communication link when the deactivation signal has been received.
- (22) An aspect of the invention also relates to a method, implemented by an electronic control module as previously described, comprising the steps of: receiving an activation request, produced by the user of the vehicle, of a so-called “silent” mode in which the transmission of detection signals by the vehicle over the wireless communication link is suspended, it being possible for communication signals generated by a physical entity other than the vehicle to be received by said vehicle, following the activation request, detecting the user device outside a predetermined area around the vehicle, activating said silent mode, by the vehicle, when the user device has been detected outside the predetermined area, receiving a signal for deactivating the silent mode, sent by the user from the user device, reauthorizing the transmission of communication signals by the vehicle over the wireless communication link when the deactivation signal has been received.
- (23) An aspect of the invention also relates to a computer program product characterized in that it contains a set of program code instructions that, when they are executed by one or more processors, configure the one or more processors to implement a method as set out above.
- (24) An aspect of the invention also relates to a motor vehicle comprising an electronic control module as described above.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Other features and advantages of aspects of the invention will become more apparent upon reading the description that follows. This description is purely illustrative and should be read with reference to the appended drawings, in which:

- (2) FIG. 1 schematically shows an embodiment of the system according to the invention;
- (3) FIG. 2 schematically shows an embodiment of the method according to the invention.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE PREFERRED EMBODIMENTS

- (4) FIG. 1 schematically shows an example of a system **1** according to an aspect of the invention.
- (5) The system **1** comprises a vehicle **10** and a device **20** carried by a user **200**.

(6) Vehicle **10**

(7) The vehicle **10** comprises an electronic control module **100**.

(8) The electronic control module **100** is configured to transmit a detection signal to the device **20** of a user **200** over a first wireless communication link.

(9) The first wireless communication link preferably uses the low-frequency radio band (LF). In other words, the first wireless communication link is of the LF type. Alternatively, the first wireless communication link could be of the BLE, Wi-Fi, Li-Fi, UWB or RAN type, or any other suitable type.

(10) The electronic control module **100** is configured to receive an activation request, produced by the user of the vehicle **10**, of a so-called “silent” mode, wherein the transmission of detection signals by the vehicle **10** over the first wireless communication link is suspended.

(11) In this silent mode, communication signals generated by a physical entity other than the vehicle **10** can be received by said vehicle **10**, over the first communication link or over a second communication link.

(12) The electronic control module **100** is configured for detecting, following an activation request of the silent mode, the device **20** of a user **200** outside a first predetermined area **ZP1** around the vehicle **10**.

(13) The electronic control module **100** is configured to activate the silent mode when the device **20** has been detected outside the first predetermined area **ZP1**.

(14) The electronic control module **100** is configured to receive a signal for deactivating the silent mode, sent by the user from the device **20**.

(15) The electronic control module **100** is configured to reauthorize the transmission of detection signals by the vehicle **10** over the first wireless communication link when a deactivation signal has been received.

(16) The electronic control module **100** comprises a processor capable of implementing a set of instructions enabling these functions to be carried out.

(17) Device **20**

(18) The device **20** is configured for receiving detection signals transmitted by the electronic control module **100** over a first wireless communication link and for communicating with the electronic control module **100** over a second wireless communication link.

(19) In a preferred embodiment, the first wireless communication link is of the LF type and the second wireless communication link is of the RF type. It will be noted however that, in another embodiment, the first wireless communication link and the second wireless communication link could be the same type, or even coincident.

(20) Implementation

(21) First, in a step **E1**, the user requests the activation of the silent mode **MS**. This request may be produced via a button or a touch screen inside the vehicle **10** or else via the device **20**. A confirmation may be requested from the user.

(22) Following the activation request, the electronic control module **100** detects the device **20** outside the first predetermined area **ZP1** around the vehicle **10**, for example when it leaves said first predetermined area **ZP1**, in a step **E2**.

(23) Then, in a step **E3**, the electronic control module **100** activates the silent mode **MS** when the device **20** has been detected outside the first predetermined area **ZP1** and, advantageously, at the end of a predetermined period. This predetermined period can advantageously be set by the user beforehand, for example via a touch-sensitive interface of the vehicle **10**.

(24) At this time, the vehicle **10** transmits no more detection signals, which makes it possible on the one hand to save electrical energy and, on the other hand, can remove the risk of hacking of the vehicle **10** via the detection signal.

(25) When the user returns to the vehicle, in particular enters a second predetermined area **ZP2** around the vehicle, the device **20** transmits, on request from the user or else automatically, a signal

SDES for deactivating the silent mode, to the electronic control module **100**, for example over an RF (radiofrequency) communication link, so as to reauthorize the transmission of detection signals by the vehicle **10** over the first wireless communication link in a step E4. In a preferred example, the first predetermined area ZP1 corresponds to an area of coverage of an LF signal over the first communication link and the second predetermined area ZP2 corresponds to an area of coverage of an RF signal over the second communication link. In this case, the first predetermined area ZP1 and the second predetermined area ZP2 are different. In another embodiment, the first predetermined area ZP1 and the second predetermined area ZP2 could be identical.

(26) Use of the silent mode can preferably be configured by the user. For example, the user can configure the electronic control module **100** so that it does not use the silent mode, or else so that it only uses it after requesting confirmation and with confirmation, or else that it uses it after requesting confirmation and without confirmation.

(27) In an embodiment, the activation of the silent mode at the end of a predetermined period allows the user to return to the vehicle before the silent mode is activated, in other words without this return yet being automatically detectable. This predetermined period counter can hence, for example, enable the user to return and search for a forgotten item in the vehicle, and to depart again without being detected so that the silent mode remains activated.

(28) The invention can therefore advantageously save energy of the vehicle when the user is far from the vehicle and, in particular, for a significant duration, for example when he leaves his vehicle in an airport parking lot for a significantly long period.

Claims

1. A method for managing transmissions, by a motor vehicle, of signals for detecting a device of a user over a wireless communication link, said method comprising: requesting activation, by the user of the vehicle, of a so-called “silent” mode in which the transmission of detection signals by the vehicle over the wireless communication link is suspended, it being possible for communication signals generated by a physical entity other than the vehicle to be received by said vehicle, following the activation request, detecting the device of a user outside a predetermined area around the vehicle, activating said silent mode by the vehicle when the device of a user has been detected outside the predetermined area, and sending to the vehicle, by the user, a signal to deactivate the silent mode from the user device so as to reauthorize the transmission of detection signals by the vehicle over the wireless communication link, wherein the activation request is produced by the user from inside the vehicle.

2. The method as claimed in claim 1, wherein the activation request is produced by the user from inside the vehicle by pressing a button or via a touch screen.

3. The method as claimed in claim 1, wherein the activation request is produced by the user from inside the vehicle via the device of a user.

4. The method as claimed in claim 1, wherein the activation request is produced by the user from outside the vehicle via the device of a user.

5. A method for managing transmissions, by a motor vehicle, of signals for detecting a device of a user over a wireless communication link, said method comprising: requesting activation, by the user of the vehicle, of a so-called “silent” mode in which the transmission of detection signals by the vehicle over the wireless communication link is suspended, it being possible for communication signals generated by a physical entity other than the vehicle to be received by said vehicle, following the activation request, detecting the device of a user outside a predetermined area around the vehicle, activating said silent mode by the vehicle when the device of a user has been detected outside the predetermined area, and sending to the vehicle, by the user, a signal to deactivate the silent mode from the user device so as to reauthorize the transmission of detection signals by the vehicle over the wireless communication link, wherein the activation of the silent

mode by the vehicle is carried out when the device of a user has been detected outside the predetermined area and at the end of a predetermined duration.

6. The method as claimed in claim 1, wherein the device of a user is an electronic key, a badge or a smartphone.

7. The method as claimed in claim 1, wherein the signal for deactivating the silent mode is sent over a second wireless communication link or else is generated following the activation of a button of the vehicle.

8. An electronic control module for a motor vehicle, said electronic control module being configured for: receiving an activation request, produced by the user of the vehicle from inside the vehicle, of a so-called “silent” mode in which the transmission of detection signals by the vehicle over the wireless communication link is suspended, it being possible for communication signals generated by a physical entity other than the vehicle to be received by said vehicle, following the activation request, detecting the device of a user outside a predetermined area around the vehicle, activating said silent mode by the vehicle when the device of a user has been detected outside the predetermined area, receiving a signal for deactivating the silent mode, sent by the user from the device of a user, and reauthorizing the transmission of detection signals by the vehicle over the wireless communication link when the deactivation signal has been received.

9. A motor vehicle comprising an electronic control module as claimed in claim 8.
